

Worksheet 103 · Skills S3.2 · Analysing non-fictional texts

Questions on the text — your scaffold

One routine for every factual text. Fill in the gaps while we work on the Baxter text (book p. 230).

0 Know the task — the operator tells you what to do

I Comprehension	describe, outline, sum up	What does the text say?
II Analysis	analyse, examine, explain	How does it say it — and why?
III Evaluation	comment, discuss, assess	What do you think — and why?

1 Step 1 · Preparation

- Read the questions first, mark the operators.
- Skim: headline, lead, first and last paragraph.
- Read the whole text, mark key words.
- Purpose: text type, source, date, target group.
- Understand: 3–6 words per section in the margin.

Baxter, *Helsinki's huge VR gig ...*

Topic	<u>virtual concert in Helsinki; future of VR tourism</u>
Text type	<u>feature article with personal report</u>
Target group	<u>general readers, not tech experts</u>
Purpose	<u>to inform and to entertain</u>

Connect: How does the target group explain the way Baxter writes?

She writes for non-experts, so she uses a personal story and explains technical terms.

2 Step 2 · Writing

2a Introductory sentence (first answer only)

In the [text type] "[title]", published in [source] in [date], [author] [reporting verb] [topic].

In her feature article "Helsinki's huge VR gig and the potential of virtual tourism", published in The Guardian online in 2020, Sarah Baxter reports on a virtual concert and explores the future of virtual tourism.

2b Comprehension (I)

- only what is asked
- own words + line references
- present tense, no opinion

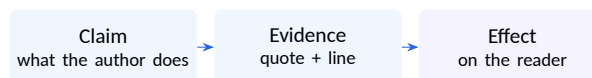
Our extra rule:

Pick up the question in the first sentence.

Our model paragraph (Baxter: respect for Helsinki's achievements) — mark C, E, E:

(C) Baxter expresses respect for Helsinki's achievements through appreciative vocabulary. (E) Although she admits that the gig lacked "the buzz of being at a 'proper' concert" (ll. 11–12), she stresses that "technically, it was impressive" (ll. 12–13). (E) Because she first concedes a weakness, her praise sounds balanced and credible, so readers are more likely to share her positive view.

2c Analysis (II)



Thesis → one paragraph per aspect → conclusion

3 From device to effect — collect your own examples

Name the device and what it does in this text. A list of devices without effect earns little.

Device	Quote (line)	Effect on the reader
personal anecdote	"giant pineapple" (l. 5)	makes VR concrete and funny
expert quotes	Dr Timothy Jung (ll. 61–66)	authority, a credible outlook
short sentence	"It worked." (l. 30)	emphasis on the success

4 Step 3 · Editing and checking

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ I did exactly what the operator asks. | ☐ present tense, no contractions |
| ☐ Every statement has a line reference. | ☐ linking words show my line of thought |
| ☐ Quotes are exact and marked "...". | ☐ precise verbs instead of says |
| ☐ My opinion only where asked (III). | ☐ no repetition |

5 Language you need**Reporting verbs**

states · claims · argues · points out · emphasises · criticises · warns

Linking words

furthermore · however · consequently · for instance · all in all

Quoting

(l. 5) · (ll. 5–7) · paraphrase: (cf. l. 5) · omissions [...]

My phrase bank: three phrases I want to use in my next answer

Effect phrases

... emphasises / underlines ... · ... creates the impression that ... · ... makes the reader feel ...

Tone

neutral · enthusiastic · sceptical · ironic · emotive · urgent

Online: step-by-step course, more phrases and the writing coach: edu-mrh.de → Englisch → Klasse 13 → Questions on the Text